# Domestic Violence & Safety

You are not alone. Help is available. Your safety matters — confidential support is here.

**National DV Hotline: 1-800-799-7233 (SAFE)**
24/7 · Confidential · Text START to 88788 · Chat: thehotline.org

## RECOGNIZING ABUSE

Domestic violence (intimate partner violence) includes any behavior used to gain power and control over a partner. Abuse is **never your fault**.

**Physical**
Hitting, pushing, choking, restraining

**Emotional**
Threats, humiliation, isolation, control

**Financial**
Controlling money, preventing employment

**Digital**
Tracking location, monitoring messages, account control

**Sexual**
Any unwanted sexual contact or coercion

**Reproductive**
Preventing contraception, forced pregnancy/abortion

## WARNING SIGNS IN A RELATIONSHIP

- Partner controls who you see, where you go, what you wear
- Jealousy or possessiveness presented as "love"
- Partner checks your phone, tracks your location constantly
- Threats of harm to you, children, or pets
- Blame — "You made me do this"
- Financial control — limits access to money or employment
- Isolation from family and friends
- Making you feel like everything is your fault
- Extreme mood swings — "walking on eggshells" feeling

## CREATING A SAFETY PLAN

1. **Identify a safe person** — a trusted friend, family member, or neighbor who knows your situation
2. **Memorize key numbers:** Police (911), hotline, trusted contact. Don't rely only on your phone.
3. **Pack an emergency bag:** ID, medication, cash, important documents (keep hidden or at trusted person's home)
4. **Know your exits** — identify escape routes from your home and plan where you will go
5. **Clear your digital trail** — use incognito mode; call from a trusted location or friend's phone if needed
6. **Teach children a safety plan** — code word, where to go, who to call

## LOCAL & NATIONAL RESOURCES

**National DV Hotline**
**1-800-799-7233 | Text: 88788**
24/7 confidential support, safety planning, local referrals. thehotline.org

**Bay Area Turning Point (Webster/Clear Lake)**
**281-286-2525 (24-hr crisis line)**
Emergency shelter, legal advocacy, counseling, support groups in the Clear Lake area

**Emergency**
**911**
If you are in immediate danger, call 911 or leave immediately if it is safe to do so

**Texas Legal Aid**
**1-800-939-1201 | texaslawhelp.org**
Free legal help for protective orders, custody issues, and immigration concerns

**This Is a Safe Place. We Are Mandated to Help.**
Our entire office is a confidential, safe environment. If you are experiencing abuse, please tell Dr. Klein or any staff member. We can connect you with resources confidentially. You deserve to feel safe. Help is available — you are not alone.